VOL. I WEEKDAY EDITION

THE SPACEX DISPATCH

Weekday briefing on SpaceX launches, Starlink, AI and the SPCX stock

FRIDAY, OCTOBER 9, 2026 MARKET DATA AS OF THU OCT 8 CLOSE

THE MORNING PICTURE

SpaceX buys its way into the phone business, and carrier stocks take the hit

After the market closed on Thursday, SpaceX said it will buy Grain Management's nationwide 800 MHz spectrum portfolio, up to 14 megahertz of paired low-band airwaves that it says will let Starlink Mobile "become a major mobile carrier in the US." The price was not disclosed; The Wall Street Journal reported about $8 billion in cash. The deal still needs approval from the Federal Communications Commission (FCC). By Friday morning, shares of AT&T, Verizon and T-Mobile were down 5.5% to 7.4% before the open, Reuters reported.

The news came too late to help SPCX, which fell 4.19% to $160.57 during Thursday's session, its second straight loss, before rising about 2.5% in extended trading. Up to 328.4 million more Class A shares become free to sell from Friday under the IPO lock-up schedule. Crew-12 is home after Thursday's splashdown. Next on the launch schedule: a Space Development Agency (SDA) mission early Saturday and the CRS-35 cargo flight on Tuesday. SpaceX has filed nothing new with the Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) since Thursday morning.

I · HUMAN SPACEFLIGHT & LAUNCHES

Crew-12 home; cargo Dragon rolls out this weekend

NASA and SpaceX reviewed the splashdown and set up Tuesday's station resupply flight; an SDA launch from California comes first, early Saturday.



Andrey Fedyaev, Jack Hathaway, Jessica Meir and Sophie Adenot (from left) inside Dragon Freedom aboard the recovery ship Shannon shortly after landing in the Pacific off Los Angeles on Thursday, Oct. 8, 2026.
PHOTO: NASA/KEEGAN BARBER · PUBLIC DOMAIN

A 237-day mission ends

The Dragon capsule Freedom splashed down off Los Angeles at 11:34 a.m. EDT Thursday. NASA said the crew's 237 days aboard the International Space Station (ISS) included research into medicine, quantum science and 3D printing with metal. The crew of NASA astronauts Jessica Meir and Jack Hathaway, European Space Agency (ESA) astronaut Sophie Adenot and Roscosmos cosmonaut Andrey Fedyaev was lifted aboard the recovery ship Shannon.

> *"I am always relieved, grateful and proud when we complete a crew mission— welcome home to Mother Earth Crew 12!"*
>
> GWYNNE SHOTWELL, PRESIDENT AND COO · @GWYNNE_SHOTWELL · POST, THU 5:05 P.M. EDT

Next cargo run: Tuesday

At a post-splashdown teleconference, Lee Echerd, a senior mission manager at SpaceX, said Falcon 9 and Dragon will roll out of the hangar at Space Launch Complex 40 this weekend, with the final launch readiness review on Monday, Spaceflight Now reported. The 35th Commercial Resupply Services mission (CRS-35) is set for 6:33 a.m. EDT Tuesday, October 13, with a backup at 6:08 a.m. EDT Wednesday. Dragon would dock at about 11:00 a.m. EDT Thursday, October 15, SpaceX said. It carries more than 6,300 pounds, according to NASA, including the last two ISS Roll-Out Solar Arrays and an empty container that will bring home a failed Canadarm2 joint removed during a June 30 spacewalk (Spaceflight Now).

SDA launch set for Saturday

Falcon 9 is due to launch 21 Northrop Grumman-built satellites for the SDA's Tranche 1 Transport Layer at 3:29 a.m. EDT

Saturday from Vandenberg Space Force Base in California. It is the fourth of six such missions. SpaceX moved it on Wednesday from Friday, saying "additional time allows for double checks on vehicle systems and range deconfliction." Friday morning's Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) operations plan advisory lists a 3:29 to 4:34 a.m. EDT window Saturday and a backup Sunday.

QUICK HIT

Dragon fleet. Echerd said the capsule Resilience, which flew Inspiration4, Polaris Dawn and Fram2, stays in its free-flier configuration, while the other Crew Dragons remain in service for now (Spaceflight Now). NASA's Bill Spetch said a Cygnus mission is planned toward the end of the year (Spaceflight Now).

II · UPCOMING FLIGHTS

Four Falcon 9s in six days; Starship eyes November

Every SpaceX launch on the books for the next two months, with how firm each date is and where it comes from. Times are Eastern Daylight Time (EDT); date changes are noted under each mission.

DATE / TIME (EDT)	VEHICLE	MISSION	PAD	STATUS	SOURCES
Sat Oct 10, 3:29 a.m.	Falcon 9	SDA Tranche 1 Transport Layer A, 21 satellites (fourth of six); booster B1103, 6th flight. **Moved** Wednesday from Fri Oct 9 for vehicle double checks and range deconfliction (SpaceX); aborted Oct 5	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	CONFIRMED	SpaceX post; Spaceflight Now; FAA advisory 3:29–4:34 a.m., backup Sun 3:21–4:26 a.m.
Mon Oct 12, 7:00 p.m.	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-25, 27 V2 Mini satellites; booster B1088, 20th flight. **Moved** from Oct 10 and 11 (first Sep 30); no reason given	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	TENTATIVE	Spaceflight Now; Launch Library 2
Tue Oct 13, 6:33 a.m.	Falcon 9 / Cargo Dragon	CRS-35 to the ISS, more than 6,300 lb; Dragon C211, 4th flight; booster B1096, 8th flight; backup Wed Oct 14, 6:08 a.m.; docking Thu Oct 15, about 11:00 a.m.	SLC-40, Cape Canaveral	CONFIRMED	SpaceX; NASA; Spaceflight Now; FAA advisory 6:24–7:14 a.m.
Thu Oct 15, 7:44 p.m.	Falcon 9	USSF-481, US Space Force	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	TENTATIVE	Launch Library 2
NET October	Falcon 9	Bandwagon-5 rideshare	SLC-40, Cape Canaveral	PRELIMINARY	Launch Library 2
NET November	Falcon 9	Cygnus NG-25 cargo to the ISS	SLC-40, Cape Canaveral	PRELIMINARY	Launch Library 2; NASA: "towards the end of the year" (Spaceflight Now)
NET Sun Nov 8	**Starship**	**Flight 15**	**Pad 2, Starbase, Texas**	PRELIMINARY	**NASASpaceflight unofficial schedule; Launch Library 2 lists Q4 2026**
NET Thu Dec 10	Starship	Flight 16	Possibly LC-39A, Kennedy	PRELIMINARY	NASASpaceflight unofficial schedule

Status: Confirmed means the operator or NASA has announced the date and time. Tentative means a specific date appears in published schedules but has not been confirmed by SpaceX or its customer. Preliminary means only a no-earlier-than (NET) month or an unofficial target. Sources: SpaceX on X and its CRS-35 mission page; NASA; Spaceflight Now launch schedule (updated Oct 8); Launch Library 2 (The Space Devs); NASASpaceflight; FAA Air Traffic Control System Command Center operations plan advisory 023, issued 7:47 a.m. EDT Friday. That advisory still lists a Starlink 15-25 window from Sat Oct 10, 7:00–11:43 p.m. EDT, since superseded by the Monday target. Launch Library 2 times for USSF-481 are unofficial. No changes to these dates since Thursday's issue. Pads: Space Launch Complex 4 East (SLC-4E), Space Launch Complex 40 (SLC-40), Launch Complex 39A (LC-39A).



A Falcon 9 lifts off from Space Launch Complex 4E at Vandenberg Space Force Base with NASA's SWOT satellite on Dec. 16, 2022. Saturday's SDA launch uses the same pad.

PHOTO: NASA/KEEGAN BARBER · PUBLIC DOMAIN

Starship status

Starship last flew on September 28. Flight 14 was the first Starship flight to place satellites, a batch of Starlink V3 spacecraft, into a stable low Earth orbit (Launch Library 2), and the ship splashed down north of Hawaii (Spaceflight Now).

An unofficial schedule from NASASpaceflight, posted Thursday, lists Flight 15 from Starbase Pad 2 no earlier than November 8 and Flight 16, potentially from Launch Complex 39A in Florida, no earlier than December 10. No new FAA license action has been published; comments on Starship at Space Launch Complex 37 close Wednesday (Section VI).

"A major mobile carrier in the US"

SpaceX agreed to buy nationwide low-band spectrum, the piece it says Starlink Mobile was missing to work indoors. The FCC still has to sign off.

14 MHz	~$8B	$2.9B	15,000
Paired 800 MHz spectrum, nationwide, in the Grain portfolio	Cash price reported by The Wall Street Journal; not disclosed by the companies	Cash T-Mobile received from Grain for the same licenses in August, plus 600 MHz spectrum	Next-generation direct-to-cell satellites the FCC approved this week

What SpaceX is buying

SpaceX announced the agreement at 4:19 p.m. EDT Thursday. In a company update, it said the portfolio of up to 14 megahertz of paired spectrum "addresses one of the key remaining technical gaps." Once the FCC approves, Starlink Mobile plans to combine its satellites with "an advanced terrestrial deployment." The 2 GHz band SpaceX bought from EchoStar would carry high-bandwidth capacity, while the 800 MHz layer is meant to get through walls and reach phones inside buildings. "Critically, most existing mobile devices already support this underused band," SpaceX said.

> *"With this new low-band spectrum and our Gen2 constellation, Starlink Mobile can now become the first network operator to deploy both satellite and terrestrial spectrum. One network that provides Americans with a reliable service indoors, outdoors, in cellular dead zones, and everywhere in between."*
>
> SPACEX · UPDATE, THURSDAY, OCTOBER 8

Grain Management, a Washington, D.C., digital-infrastructure investor, said SpaceX will acquire 100% of the portfolio, subject to FCC approval and customary closing conditions.

Grain bought the licenses from T-Mobile in August for $2.9 billion in cash plus its own 600 MHz licenses, MarketWatch reported. Grain said the sale advances the FCC's July 2026 order approving that purchase, which set up a competitive selection process and "a conditional pathway" for direct-to-device service. Neither side disclosed a price; Reuters, citing The Wall Street Journal, put it at about $8 billion in cash.

"The last critical piece"

Elon Musk (@elonmusk) wrote: "This is the last critical piece of the spectrum puzzle needed for SpaceX to provide complete phone coverage in America." Replying to investor Chamath Palihapitiya, who called it "a very big deal," Musk added: "To the casual observer, this won't seem like much. To those who understand the spectrum wars, it's an earthquake." Michael Nicolls (@michaelnicollsx), vice president of Starlink engineering, posted "Big day for @Starlink Mobile..."

The same company update recapped Tuesday's FCC approval of the Gen2 direct-to-cell constellation: 15,000 satellites optimized for 2 GHz spectrum, which SpaceX says will deliver more than 100 times the bandwidth of the current generation, plus the full set of Ka-, V-, E- and W-band backhaul frequencies used by Starlink's V3 broadband satellites.

India: "We are ready to serve in India, once India is ready"

India's Ministry of Communications called claims that its satellite rules are applied in a discriminatory way "baseless and misconceived." It said Starlink, Eutelsat OneWeb and Jio Satellite Communications all hold licenses, all face security assessments now under way, and sit at "broadly the same regulatory stage," Hindustan Times reported. Starlink still needs security clearance and a spectrum assignment before it can sell service. At the India Mobile Congress, Starlink vice president Lauren Dreyer said the company has built 20 gateway sites with hundreds of antennas around India's security rules: "We are ready to serve in India, once India is ready."

Jio, owned by Mukesh Ambani's Reliance, is reported to be planning about 1,600 low Earth orbit satellites and 23 ground stations, CNBC noted, citing local media. Akash Ambani, chairman of Reliance Jio Infocomm, told the same conference that Jio is developing its own satellite technology (BBC). Musk kept up the pressure Thursday afternoon, quoting a post that argued India needs Starlink as an emergency backup: "Starlink saves lives during natural disasters."

IV · THE CARRIER FIGHT

Phone stocks slide on both sides of the Atlantic

Carriers fell, tower owners rose, and analysts argued over how fast a satellite-first network can take customers.

AT&T, Verizon and T-Mobile each fell more than 7% after hours on Thursday (MarketWatch). On Friday morning they were down 5.5% to 7.4% before the open, and the STOXX Europe 600 telecommunications index lost more than 2%, its lowest since January 30, Reuters reported. Deutsche Telekom fell 6.5%, Vodafone 4.1%, Telefónica 3.9% and Orange 2.3%.

> *"We believe the Grain transaction is a clear sign that SpaceX is going to be a more aggressive acquirer of spectrum."*
>
> MORGAN STANLEY ANALYSTS, VIA REUTERS

Morgan Stanley added that any threat to established carriers will likely build gradually, starting in rural markets. Tim Farrar of TMF Associates told CNBC: "This adds fuel to the fire in the battle between SpaceX and the mobile operators. But it's still a very limited amount of spectrum and to get reliable building penetration in urban areas SpaceX would have to deploy towers on the ground."

QUICK HIT

Tower owners rallied. American Tower, Crown Castle and SBA Communications rose 6.7% to 8.3% Friday morning; Morgan Stanley called the deal "incrementally constructive" for them, since even a satellite-centric network needs towers, rooftops and small cells (Reuters).

A relationship already fraying

Last week AT&T, T-Mobile and Verizon launched a joint venture to pool spectrum for satellite coverage beyond their towers, run by interim CEO Paul Roth, and the three have said they do not plan to sign wholesale (MVNO) deals with SpaceX, Light Reading reported. T-Mobile, Starlink's U.S. direct-to-cell partner, recently removed Starlink references from its T-Satellite promotions (CNBC). In August, SpaceX President Gwynne Shotwell said she expects Starlink to "acquire quite a few of their customers because I think our service will be better" (MarketWatch).

Starlink had 12 million subscribers in 205 countries as of June 30, and its connectivity business earned $1.66 billion of operating income on $4.29 billion of revenue in the second quarter, CNBC noted. Deutsche Bank estimated 13.5 million subscribers at the end of September, 4.1 million of them in the U.S.

V · AI & COMPUTE

Musk's biggest claim yet

No update on the reported $40 billion chip financing; SpaceXAI kept shipping Grok products and funding open-source work.

> *"This will sound super crazy, but I see a path to SpaceX being worth orders of magnitude more than the current Earth economy"*
>
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · POST, THU 5:55 P.M. EDT

The reported talks with Apollo and banks on about $40 billion of debt to buy Nvidia chips were still weighing on the stock Thursday, TipRanks said. Neither company has confirmed them. On the model side, Musk wrote "Grok 4.7 ranks first in legal matters," quoting Artificial Analysis's updated Legal Agent Benchmark, which now includes a hallucination check. SpaceXAI's Grok Imagine released Video 1.5 Lite in its developer interface at $0.02 a second for 480p, $0.03 for 720p and $0.14 for 1080p.

QUICK HIT

David Heinemeier Hansson @dhh, creator of Ruby on Rails and the Omarchy Linux setup, said SpaceXAI joined the Omacom Foundation as a founding corporate patron with $1.5 million in Grok tokens. SpaceXAI replied: "We are glad to support the Omarchy team."

The spectrum deal heads for an FCC review

No new SEC or FAA filings; the Grain purchase now needs the FCC's approval, and this week's satellite license carries deadlines.

SEC

> No filings for Space Exploration Technologies Corp. (CIK 0001181412) were accepted on the SEC's Electronic Data Gathering, Analysis, and Retrieval system (EDGAR) between 8:00 a.m. EDT Thursday and 8:38 a.m. EDT Friday; SpaceX has not filed an 8-K on the spectrum agreement. Latest insider filings:

Form 4/A · Sep 30 · Antonio Gracias, director — Amends his September 15 report of the September 11 in-kind distribution of 42,790,223 shares by Valor entities. He reports 460,624,307 shares afterward. Filing

Form 4 · Sep 24 · Gwynne Shotwell, President and Chief Operating Officer — On September 22 she exercised options for 342,170 shares (138,900 at $8.3998, 74,405 at $11.20 and 128,865 at $19.40) and sold the same number at weighted-average prices of $151.15 to $154.72. She holds 2,472,035 shares afterward. Filing

FAA

> No new FAA licenses, license modifications or environmental notices for SpaceX appeared on the FAA's commercial space pages or in the Federal Register since Thursday morning. Latest on record:

Notice of intent · Sep 29 — Supplemental Environmental Impact Statement (SEIS) on Starship operations at Space Launch Complex 37, Cape Canaveral: up to 76 launches and 152 landings a year. Scoping comments are due Wednesday, October 14 (docket FAA-2026-10792; 91 FR 61551). Federal Register

Final environmental assessment · Sep 4 — Finding of no significant impact for Starship reentry contingency operations in the Pacific Ocean and an additional Starship landing trajectory (docket FAA-2026-6968; 91 FR 56939). Federal Register

FCC

New · Oct 8 · 800 MHz purchase — SpaceX's purchase of Grain's nationwide 800 MHz licenses is subject to FCC approval. Grain cites the FCC's July 2026 order approving its own purchase from T-Mobile, which set a competitive selection process and a conditional path to direct-to-device use. Grain · SpaceX

Oct 6 · Gen2 direct-to-device order — The Space and Wireless Telecommunications bureaus granted in part SpaceX's 15,000-satellite system. SpaceX must post a surety bond by November 4 and had 30 days from release to decline the conditioned grant; 7,500 satellites must operate by October 7, 2032, and all by October 7, 2035. U.S. service in the former EchoStar 2 GHz bands waits for Step Two of that deal to close. Exterra · Light Reading

Oct 29 · Open meeting — Votes on making 482 MHz more spectrum available for Supplemental Coverage from Space and on a proposed auction of 25 MHz at 1675–1695 and 2020–2025 MHz for terrestrial 5G, direct-to-device service or both. Broadband Breakfast

Takeaways

1. SpaceX agreed to buy nationwide 800 MHz spectrum from Grain, reportedly for about $8 billion, to make Starlink Mobile a full U.S. carrier; the FCC must approve.
2. Carrier stocks in the U.S. and Europe fell; tower owners rose.
3. SPCX fell 4.19% Thursday to $160.57, then rose after hours on the deal.
4. Up to 328.4 million more Class A shares can be sold from Friday; the next tranche is October 24.
5. Launches: SDA mission Saturday at 3:29 a.m. EDT; CRS-35 Tuesday at 6:33 a.m. EDT.

SOURCES

X posts from @SpaceX, @SpaceXAI, @elonmusk, @Gwynne_Shotwell, @michaelnicollsx, @NASA, @SpaceflightNow, @NASASpaceflight, @dhh, @imagine; SpaceX updates and mission pages; Grain Management; NASA; CNBC, Reuters, MarketWatch, The Wall Street Journal (via Reuters), Light Reading, Exterra, Broadband Breakfast, Hindustan Times, BBC, TipRanks/TheFly; Spaceflight Now, Launch Library 2; FAA, Federal Register; SEC EDGAR; Yahoo Finance via yfinance; CBOE. Photos: NASA (public domain).

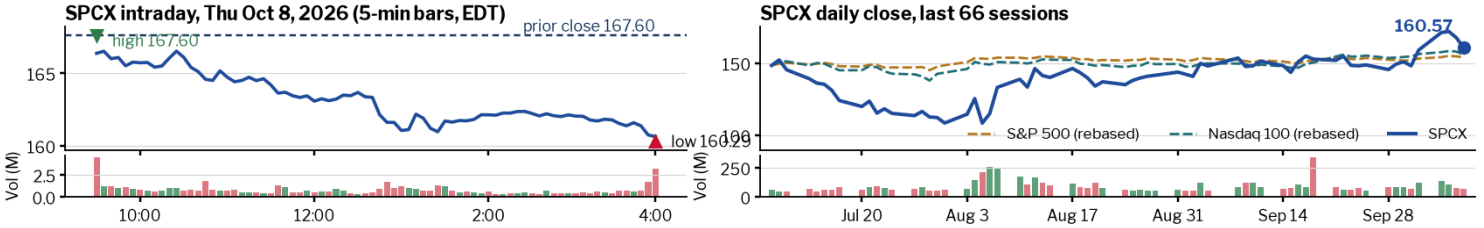
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SPCX slides 4.2% before the spectrum news

Shares fell for a second day as the reported chip financing, a new Hold rating and Friday's lock-up release weighed, then rose about 2.5% after hours on the Grain deal.

CLOSE	CHANGE	OPEN	DAY HIGH	DAY LOW
$160.57	**−$7.03**	**$167.47**	**$167.60**	**$160.00**
Thu Oct 8, 4:00 p.m. EDT	*−4.19% vs $167.60*	*regular session*	*first 5 minutes*	*near the close*
VOLUME	**RANGE SINCE IPO**	**MARKET CAP**	**5-DAY / 1-MONTH**	**SINCE LISTING**
70.38M	**$105–$226**	**$2.12T**	**+8.44% / +8.82%**	**+18.9%**
−20.7% vs 30-session avg 88.80M	*no 52-week history (listed Jun 12)*	*13.18B Class A+B shares × close; $2.18T with Cursor shares*	*5 and 21 sessions*	*vs $135 IPO price; −0.24% vs first close*

SINCE IPO, OCT 8 — low $104.83 · Aug 3 | close $160.57 | high $225.64 · Jun 16; 50-day avg $143.23



As of close Oct 8, 2026; times EDT. Source: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (regular session, unadjusted). Dashed navy = prior close; triangles = session high/low; volume green/red = up/down vs prior bar; index lines rebased to the first close shown.

RELATIVE PERFORMANCE, AS OF OCT 8 CLOSE

TICKER	1-DAY	5-DAY	1-MONTH	SINCE JUN 12
SPCX	**−4.19%**	**+8.44%**	**+8.82%**	**−0.24%**
S&P 500	−0.47%	+1.29%	+1.69%	+4.49%
Nasdaq 100	−1.39%	+0.74%	+4.43%	+3.68%
RKLB	−4.89%	−2.92%	+8.45%	−33.20%
ASTS	−6.13%	−0.19%	−8.80%	−30.92%
IRDM	−1.65%	−0.65%	+1.06%	+0.51%

OPTIONS SNAPSHOT (CBOE, FRI OCT 9, 8:38 A.M. EDT)

EXPIRY	CALL OI	PUT OI	P/C	ATM IV	TOP CALL / PUT
Oct 9	206,264	210,697	1.02	51.8%	$180 / $160
Oct 12	46,390	20,524	0.44	37.8%	$170 / $150
Oct 14	11,260	6,626	0.59	43.1%	$170 / $165
All expiries	**2,340,288**	**2,479,763**	**1.06**		**30-day IV index 49.4**

ANALYST CONSENSUS · OCT 9

Strong buy	7
Buy	22
Hold	5
Sell	3
Strong sell	0
Mean (1 = strong buy)	1.78
Mean target (27 analysts)	$224.56 (+39.8%)
Median target	$225.00
High / low target	$450.00 / $118.00

SHORT INTEREST & OWNERSHIP

Short interest, Sep 15	162.25M
Change vs. mid-August	−12.0%
Short % of float	2.43%
Days to cover	2.07
Held by insiders	12.73%
Held by institutions	48.44%
Alphabet, Jun 30	7.16%
Valor Management, Jun 30	6.54%

VALUATION & TREND · OCT 8 CLOSE

Trailing P/E (EPS −$1.10)	—
Forward P/E (EPS est. $1.95)	82.3
Price/sales (rev. $23.04B)	91.9
Beta	—
50-day average	$143.23 (+12.1%)
200-day average	—
Q3 EPS est. (14 analysts)	$0.16
Q3 revenue est. (15)	$12.91B

RECENT RATING ACTIONS

DATE	FIRM	RATING	TARGET
Oct 8	Erste Group	Hold (initiated)	—
Oct 7	Susquehanna	Neutral	$144 to $173
Sep 30	Macquarie	Outperform	$250
Sep 29	TD Cowen	Buy (initiated)	$200
Sep 28	Deutsche Bank	Buy	$235
Sep 28	CLSA	Outperform (initiated)	$250
Sep 14	MoffettNathanson	Neutral	$131 to $142

CATALYST CALENDAR

DATE	EVENT
Fri Oct 9	**Lock-up tranche, up to 328.4M shares; weekly expiry**
Fri Oct 16	Monthly options expiry
Sat Oct 24	Lock-up tranche: up to 328.4M more
Thu Oct 29	FCC open meeting: direct-to-device spectrum votes
Tue Nov 3	Q3 results (Yahoo estimate, not confirmed)
Wed Nov 4	FCC surety-bond deadline (15,000 satellites)
Tue Dec 8	180-day lock-up ends

Prices, volume, returns, averages: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (unadjusted; 30-session average excludes Oct 8). Consensus, targets, ratings, short interest (Sep 15), ownership (Jun 30, % of Class A) and estimates: Yahoo Finance, retrieved Fri Oct 9, 8:38 a.m. EDT; Erste Group via TheFly. P/E is price to earnings per share (EPS); price/sales uses trailing 12-month revenue. A dash marks a measure that does not apply yet: trailing P/E (negative EPS), beta and the 200-day average (listed Jun 12). Options: CBOE delayed quotes; open interest (OI) and IV as of Thursday's close; P/C is put/call by OI; ATM IV at the $160 strike. Shares: 10-Q cover (7,696,293,669 Class A + 5,485,486,276 Class B, Jul 28); $2.18T adds 391,041,680 Cursor merger shares (8-K). IPO price and lock-ups: prospectus (424B4); 1.3B more shares unlock two trading days after Q3 results. Why it fell: TipRanks; after hours: CNBC; FCC dates: Exterra.